Swagger UI is a useful tool for exploring your APIs and can replace a tool like Postman in some cases. But the examples we've shown so far reveal a problem with our API: the responses described for the `GET` endpoint in figure 11.3 mentioned a `200` response, but our execution in figure 11.4 reveals that it can also return a `404`. To solve that documentation problem, we need to add extra metadata to our APIs.

11.3 Adding metadata to your minimal APIs

Metadata is information about an API that doesn't change the execution of the API itself. You used metadata in chapter 5 when you added names to your endpoints, using `WithName()`, so that you could reference them by using `LinkGenerator`. The name doesn't change anything about how the endpoint executes, but it provides information for other features to hook into.

Currently, you can add three broad categories of metadata to minimal API endpoints:

- *Routing metadata*—As you've already seen, the `WithName()` methods adds a globally unique name to an endpoint that's used for URL generation.
- *Metadata for other middleware*—Several pieces of middleware can be customized on a per-request basis by adding metadata to an endpoint. When the middleware runs, it checks the selected endpoint's metadata and acts accordingly. Examples include authorization, hostname filtering, and output caching.
- *OpenAPI metadata*—OpenAPI document generation is driven by the metadata exposed by endpoints, which in turn controls the UI exposed by Swagger UI.